

WiFi Without Access Point

Q I want to set up WiFi at work with a single desktop and my WiFi-enabled laptop. Can I use a wireless PCI card and communicate directly with my laptop with the RF waves from both terminals? Does technology support such configuration? Or is an AP a must? Can I use only an AP connected to the desktop that will communicate with the laptop? Which brand is preferred for the hardware (AP, wireless PCI card)?

mrdedhia@yahoo.com

A You do not need an access point to setup a wireless network between your laptop and your desktop. You need to set up an Ad Hoc access point.

First, install the wireless card on your desktop. If you are using Windows XP, your card will be automatically detected and the drivers will install. If other networks are available, Windows will automatically open the window for wireless network connection. If not, click on the 'Wireless Connections' icon to open the window. If applicable,

clear all connections in preferred access points to make sure that you connect only to your laptop.

On the top right of your window, click the 'Advanced' tab and select 'Computer to Computer (Ad Hoc) networks only.' Un-tick the 'Automatically connect to non-preferred networks' box. Go back to the wireless networking tab under the preferred Networks window, click 'Add' and specify a name (SSID)—any name. The connection type would already be specified as 'Ad Hoc'. Now you will see the name of your network in the preferred networks

window marked with a red 'X', signifying that that computer is not within range.

Since your laptop is WiFi-enabled, go to the wireless networks tab and you will

see the name you gave in the above step in the "Available Networks" window. That's all you need to do to share data between the two.



Illustration Shyam Shriram

device from the device manager. Your computer should work fine now.

If all the IRQs have status 'OK', then download the Windows memory-testing program from <http://snipurl.com/c3mh>. Run it, and if it gives any errors, then assuming you have a single chip, remove your RAM chip and put it into another slot. If it works fine then your RAM slot is faulty and you will have to repair or replace your motherboard. If, however, your errors persist, then your RAM chip is definitely faulty.

If you have multiple RAM chips then insert only one of them and test it in your RAM slots, then put in the other and test as before. Identify the faulty slots and fix the problem accordingly.

Over Drive!

Q I have a Celeron 600 MHz, a Procomp motherboard and 128 MB of RAM. I have two Seagate hard disks—20 GB and 40 GB. I also have a Sony CD-ROM and an LG CD-RW. The two IDE cables are all occupied. How do I attach a DVD-ROM to my PC?

Tanmoy Das

A Install an IDE controller card to be able to add additional drives. An alternative is to remove your CD-ROM and attach the DVD-ROM in its place, as a DVD ROM drive will allow you to read CDs as well.

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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Dirty PC!

Q I have a P IV 1.6 GHz CPU with an Intel 845WN motherboard, 128 + 256 MB SD RAM, 40 + 120 GB HDDs, a 24X CD-RW, a 16X DVD-ROM and a 15-inch LG monitor. I have three OSes—Win98, Win2000 and WinXP, loaded in the 40 GB HDD in three different partitions. The problem is that my WinXP restarts abruptly without warning and this generally happens when I switch on my PC after several hours. After this, when the PC restarts, the CHKDSK operation is performed that results in some errors and when finally XP restarts, a warning indicates that the system has recovered from a serious error.

My DVD-ROM works perfectly but when I use it for some time, the BIOS stops detecting it. When I restart my PC three to four times, the BIOS detects it perfectly. This problem occurs at regular intervals and persists or does not occur at all.

Sanjeev Chharia

A Ensure that the motherboard is clean and dust free. You may want to contact a local technician to service it. Make sure all wires and cables are plugged in properly and that your RAM, video cards and all other peripherals are plugged in tightly into their sockets. As for your DVD problem, check your connection cables. They must probably be loose! ☐